

It is irrefutable that employees know the difference between right and wrong. So why don't more employees intervene when they see someone exhibiting at-risk behavior in the workplace?

There are a number of factors that influence whether people intervene. First, they need to be able to see a risky situation beginning to unfold. Second, the company's culture needs to make them feel safe to speak up. And third, they need to have the communication skills to say something effectively.

This is not strictly a workplace problem; it's a growing problem off the job too. Every day people witness things on the street and choose to stand idly by. This is known as the bystander effect—the more people who witness an event, the less likely anyone in that group is to help the victim. The psychology behind this is called diffusion of responsibility. Basically, the larger the crowd, the more people assume that someone else will take care of it—meaning no one effectively intervenes or acts in a moment of need.

This crowd mentality is strong enough for people to evade their known responsibilities. But it's not only frontline workers who don't make safety interventions in the workplace. There are also instances where supervisors do not intervene either.

When a group of employees sees unsafe behavior not being addressed at a leadership level it creates the precedent that this is how these situations should be addressed, thus defining the safety culture for everyone.

Despite the fact that workers are encouraged to intervene when they observe unsafe operations, this happens less than half of the time. Fear is the ultimate factor in not intervening. There is a fear of penalty, a fear that they'll have to do more work if they intervene. Unsuccessful attempts in the past are another strong contributing factor to why people don't intervene—they tend to prefer to defer that action to someone else for all future situations.

On many worksites, competent workers must be appointed. Part of their job is to intervene when workers perform a task without the proper equipment or if the conditions are unsafe. Competent workers are also required to stop work from continuing when there's a danger.

Supervisors also play a critical role. Even if a competent person isn't required, supervisors need a broad set of skills to not only identify and alleviate workplace hazards but also build a safety climate within their team that supports intervening and open communication among them.

Beyond competent workers and supervisors, it's important to educate everyone within the organization that they are obliged to intervene if they witness a possible unsafe act, whether you're a designated competent person, a supervisor or a frontline worker.

46. What is one of the factors contributing to failure of intervention in face of risky behavior in the workplace?

- A) Slack supervision style.
- B) Unfavorable workplace culture.
- C) Unforeseeable risk.
- D) Blocked communication.

47. What does the author mean by "diffusion of responsibility" (Line 4, Para. 3)?

- A) The more people are around, the more they need to worry about their personal safety.
- B) The more people who witness an event, the less likely anyone will venture to participate.
- C) The more people idling around on the street, the more likely they need taking care of.
- D) The more people are around, the less chance someone will step forward to intervene.

48. What happens when unsafe behavior at the workplace is not addressed by the leaders?

- A) No one will intervene when they see similar behaviors.
- B) Everyone will see it as the easiest way to deal with crisis.
- C) Workers have to take extra caution executing their duties.
- D) Workers are left to take care of the emergency themselves.

49. What is the ultimate reason workers won't act when they see unsafe operations?

- A) Preference of deferring the action to others.
- B) Anticipation of leadership intervention.
- C) Fear of being isolated by coworkers.
- D) Fear of having to do more work.

50. What is critical to ensuring workplace safety?

- A) Workers be trained to operate their equipment properly.
- B) Workers exhibiting at-risk behavior be strictly disciplined.
- C) Supervisors create a safety environment for timely intervention.
- D) Supervisors conduct effective communication with frontline workers.

Passage Two

Questions 51 to 55 are based on the following passage.

The term "environmentalist" can mean different things. It used to refer to people trying to protect wildlife and natural ecosystems. In the 21st century, the term has evolved to capture the need to combat human-made climate change.

The distinction between these two strands of environmentalism is the cause of a split within the scientific community about nuclear energy.

On one side are purists who believe nuclear power isn't worth the risk and the exclusive solution to the climate crisis is renewable energy. The opposing side agrees that renewables are crucial, but says society needs an amount of power available to meet consumers' basic demands when the sun isn't shining and the wind isn't blowing. Nuclear energy, being far cleaner than oil, gas and coal, is a natural option, especially where hydroelectric capacity is limited.

Leon Clarke, who helped author reports for the UN's Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change, isn't an uncritical supporter of nuclear energy, but says it's a valuable option to have if we're serious about reaching carbon neutrality.

"Core to all of this is the degree to which you think we can actually meet climate goals with 100% renewables," he said. "If you don't believe we can do it, and you care about the climate, you are forced to think about something like nuclear."

The achievability of universal 100% renewability is similarly contentious. Cities such as Burlington, Vermont, have been "100% renewable" for years. But these cities often have small populations, occasionally still rely on fossil fuel energy and have significant renewable resources at their immediate disposal. Meanwhile, countries that manage to run off renewables typically do so thanks to extraordinary hydroelectric capabilities.

Germany stands as the best case study for a large, industrialized country pushing into green energy. Chancellor Angela Merkel in 2011 announced Energiewende, an energy transition that would phase out nuclear and coal while phasing in renewables. Wind and solar power generation has increased over 400% since 2010, and renewables provided 46% of the country's electricity in 2019.

But progress has halted in recent years. The instability of renewables doesn't just mean energy is often not produced at night, but also that solar and wind can overwhelm the grid during the day, forcing utilities to pay customers to use their electricity. Lagging grid infrastructure struggles to transport this overabundance of green energy from Germany's north to its industrial south, meaning many factories still run on coal and gas. The political limit has also been reached in some places, with citizens meeting the construction of new wind turbines with loud protests.

The result is that Germany's greenhouse gas emissions have fallen by around 11.5% since 2010—slower than the EU average of 13.5%.

51. What accounts for the divide within the scientific community about nuclear energy?

- A) Attention to combating human-made climate change.
- B) Emphasis on protecting wildlife and natural ecosystems.
- C) Evolution of the term 'green energy' over the last century.
- D) Adherence to different interpretations of environmentalism.

52. What is the solution to energy shortage proposed by purists' opponents?

- A) Relying on renewables firmly and exclusively.
- B) Using fossil fuel and green energy alternately.
- C) Opting for nuclear energy when necessary.
- D) Limiting people's non-basic consumption.

53. What point does the author want to make with cities like Burlington as an example?

- A) It is controversial whether the goal of the whole world's exclusive dependence on renewables is attainable.
- B) It is contentious whether cities with large populations have renewable resources at their immediate disposal.

C) It is arguable whether cities that manage to run off renewables have sustainable hydroelectric capabilities.

D) It is debatable whether traditional fossil fuel energy can be done away with entirely throughout the world.

54. What do we learn about Germany regarding renewable energy?

A) It has increased its wind and solar power generation four times over the last two decades.

B) It represents a good example of a major industrialized country promoting green energy.

C) It relies on renewable energy to generate more than half of its electricity.

D) It has succeeded in reaching the goal of energy transition set by Merkel.

55. What may be one of the reasons for Germany's progress having halted in recent years?

A) Its grid infrastructure's capacity has fallen behind its development of green energy.

B) Its overabundance of green energy has forced power plants to suspend operation during daytime.

C) Its industrial south is used to running factories on conventional energy supplies.

D) Its renewable energy supplies are unstable both at night and during the day.